

HW3 Accessibility Findings

COMP-584 Week 3 — Accessibility Tools and Email Design

This report applies the accessibility guidance from the Week 3 slide to the HW3 email. The slide lists NVDA, VoiceOver, JAWS, Silktide, Axe, and Chrome as accessibility tools. It also emphasizes high color contrast, strong visual hierarchy, readability, simple usable layouts, descriptive links, semantic markup, text alternatives, and a lang attribute.

Tool review and findings

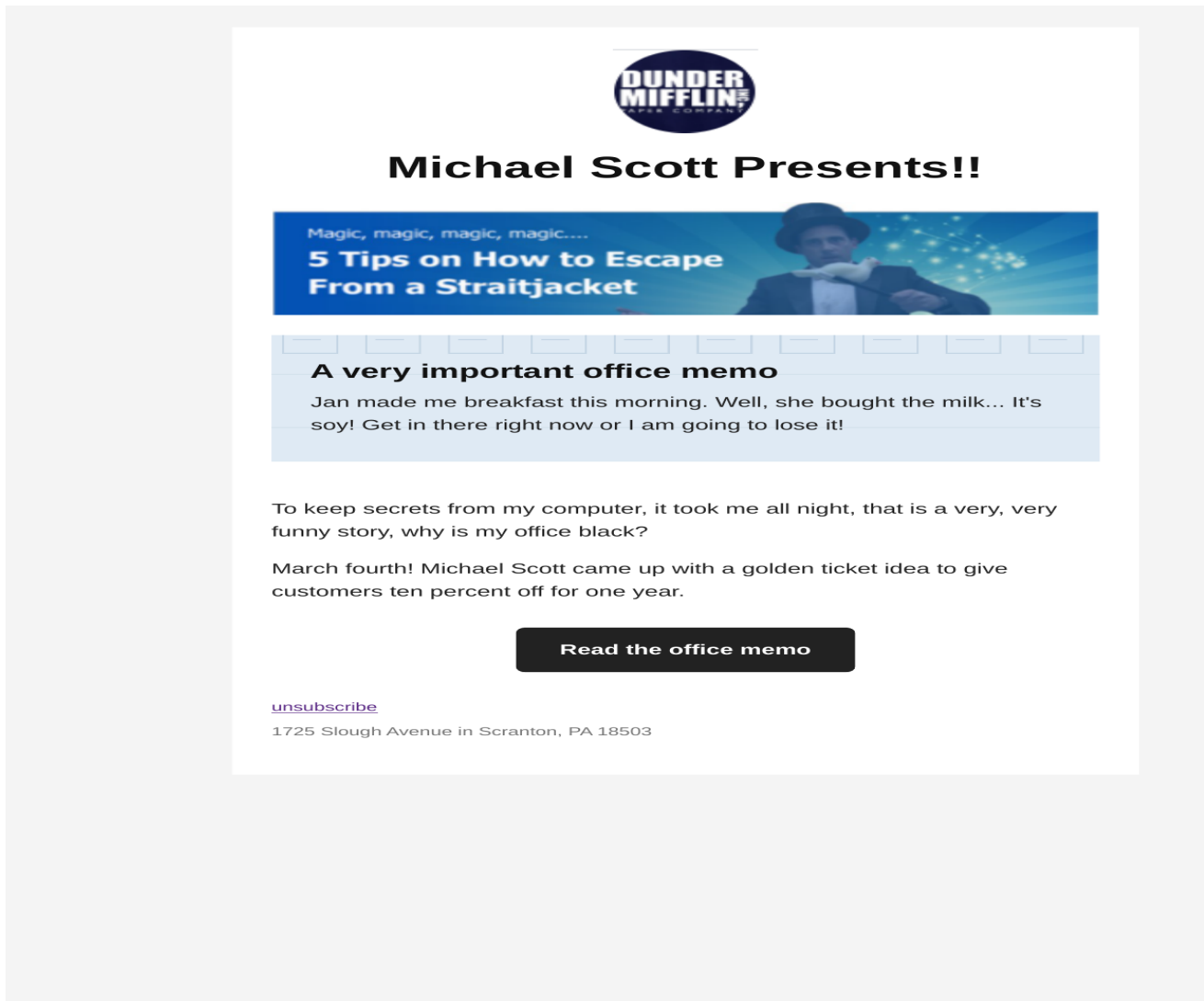
Tool	How it applies to this email	Pros / Cons
NVDA	Screen-reader perspective: headings, link text, image alt text, document structure, and presentation tables require hands-on testing; not	Pros: free, Windows and presentation tables require hands-on testing; not
VoiceOver	Screen-reader perspective for reading headings, links, images, and document structure. Cons: requires macOS for hands-on testing.	Pros: built-in, macOS. Cons: requires macOS for hands-on testing.
JAWS	Screen-reader perspective for the same semantic and navigation checks as NVDA. Cons: paid option and requires Windows.	Pros: established screen reader. Cons: paid option and requires Windows.
Silktide	Browser accessibility checking for contrast, semantics, link/image alt text, and page structure. Cons: extension/browser availability ca	Pros: easy, and page structure. Cons: extension/browser availability ca
Axe	Automated accessibility checks for common WCAG issues in the HTML. Cons: automated tools cannot detect every usa	Pros: fast, page. Cons: automated tools cannot detect every usa
Chrome	Used for desktop/mobile visual rendering and DOM-level checks in this report. Cons: not a dedicated browser and useful inspection/testing environment. Co	Pros: widely available browser and useful inspection/testing environment. Co

Implementation checklist

- ✓ **Descriptive links:** the CTA says “Read the office memo” rather than “click here.” The Week 3 slide recommends describing what happens when a person activates a link.
- ✓ **Button approach:** the CTA uses a table cell plus anchor padding/border, matching the padding + border approach shown in class.
- ✓ **Responsive hero:** the image has a fixed HTML width for Outlook plus inline display:block, max-width:100%, min-width:100px, width:100%, and height:auto behavior.
- ✓ **Alt text:** images include descriptive alternative text that explains what is happening in the image.
- ✓ **Readable text:** longer text is left aligned, with generous font size and line height.
- ✓ **Quiet tables:** layout tables use role="presentation" so assistive technology does not interpret them as data tables.
- ✓ **Language:** the document uses lang="en".
- ✓ **Single-column layout:** a 100% fluid outer table contains a 600px fixed inner table, as recommended in the lecture.
- ✓ **Background image:** the live-text memo section uses a table background image, HTML background attribute, bgcolor fallback, and inline CSS background properties for broader email-client support.

Screenshots

Desktop rendering (Chrome)



Mobile rendering (Chrome)



Michael Scott Presents!!



A very important office memo

Jan made me breakfast this morning. Well, she bought the milk... It's soy! Get in there right now or I am going to lose it!

To keep secrets from my computer, it took me all night, that is a very, very funny story, why is my office black?

March fourth! Michael Scott came up with a golden ticket idea to give customers ten percent off for one year.

[Read the office memo](#)

[unsubscribe](#)

1725 Slough Avenue in Scranton, PA 18503

Pros / cons summary

Pros: The HW3 email uses live HTML text instead of an all-image email, responsive image sizing, descriptive alt text, presentation roles on layout tables, a simple single-column structure, a larger centered CTA click area, and a background-image technique with a fallback color. These choices directly reflect the Week 3 guidance.

Cons / limitations: Screen-reader behavior varies by email client, and automated browser tools cannot prove that every email client or assistive technology will announce the content exactly as intended. NVDA, VoiceOver, and JAWS require their respective operating-system environments for hands-on testing; Silktide and Axe are browser-based tools. The screenshots in this report document Chrome desktop/mobile rendering, while the screen-reader tools are included as the manual accessibility test plan from the lecture.

Recommended manual follow-up before submission: open the hosted page and run the email through NVDA/JAWS on Windows or VoiceOver on macOS, then run Silktide and Axe in Chrome. Check that headings are understandable, links are descriptive, images have useful alt text, layout tables are not announced as data tables, and the button remains easy to activate.